



AT HIS DESK

Posing next to the tools of his trade, Nobel was both a chemist and an industrialist. After inventing dynamite, he amassed a great fortune from the manufacture and sale of explosives.



Dynamite sticks with long fuses to light them

1875

Nobel invents gelignite, a moldable explosive that is safer to handle and store than dynamite. It is also more powerful than dynamite.

1888

Ludvig, another one of Alfred's brothers, dies. Newspapers mistakenly run an obituary of Alfred, calling him "the merchant of death."

1896

Aged 63, Nobel dies in San Remo, Italy, from heart failure. He leaves his vast wealth to fund awards that would become known as the Nobel Prize.